

Exploring the Relationship Between Congressional-Bureaucratic Lettermarking and Campaign Contributions: A Case Study of the Federal Energy Regulatory Commission

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Abstract

In this paper we explore whether congressional letter-marking activity is driven by campaign contributions in the context of the Federal Energy Regulatory Commission. Drawing on 10 years worth of letters from legislators to the commission, we find that these letters are filled with specific references to companies (and in some instances the CEOs) they are seeking to assist. We match these letters with campaign finance records to see whether Members' efforts are primarily concerned with their donors or their constituents.

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1 Introduction